TradeCraft
Illustrated User Manual

The Trade Review System for Serious Traders
Know Yourself. Trade Better.

LOCAL-FIRST	ENGLISH UI	RANDOMIZED DEMO

Every account value, trade, position, return, symbol, and audit conclusion shown in this manual comes from a randomized synthetic Demo workspace. No real personal data is included.

v0.1.0 | English edition | Apache-2.0

TradeCraft is a local-first trade review system for active traders. It reconstructs trades from brokerage exports, places executions back into market context, separates outcome from process, and turns confirmed findings into rules that can be checked over the next 20 trading days.

> TradeCraft does not recommend stocks, predict markets, connect to a brokerage account, or place orders. It is research and journaling software, not investment advice.

All account values, trades, positions, returns, symbols, and audit conclusions shown in this manual come from a randomized synthetic Demo workspace. They are not real personal data.

1. Install and start TradeCraft

TradeCraft supports Python 3.11 and 3.12.

```
git clone https://github.com/Jincrediblez/TradeCraft_opensource.git
cd TradeCraft_opensource

python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate
python -m pip install -r requirements.txt
python app/main.py
```

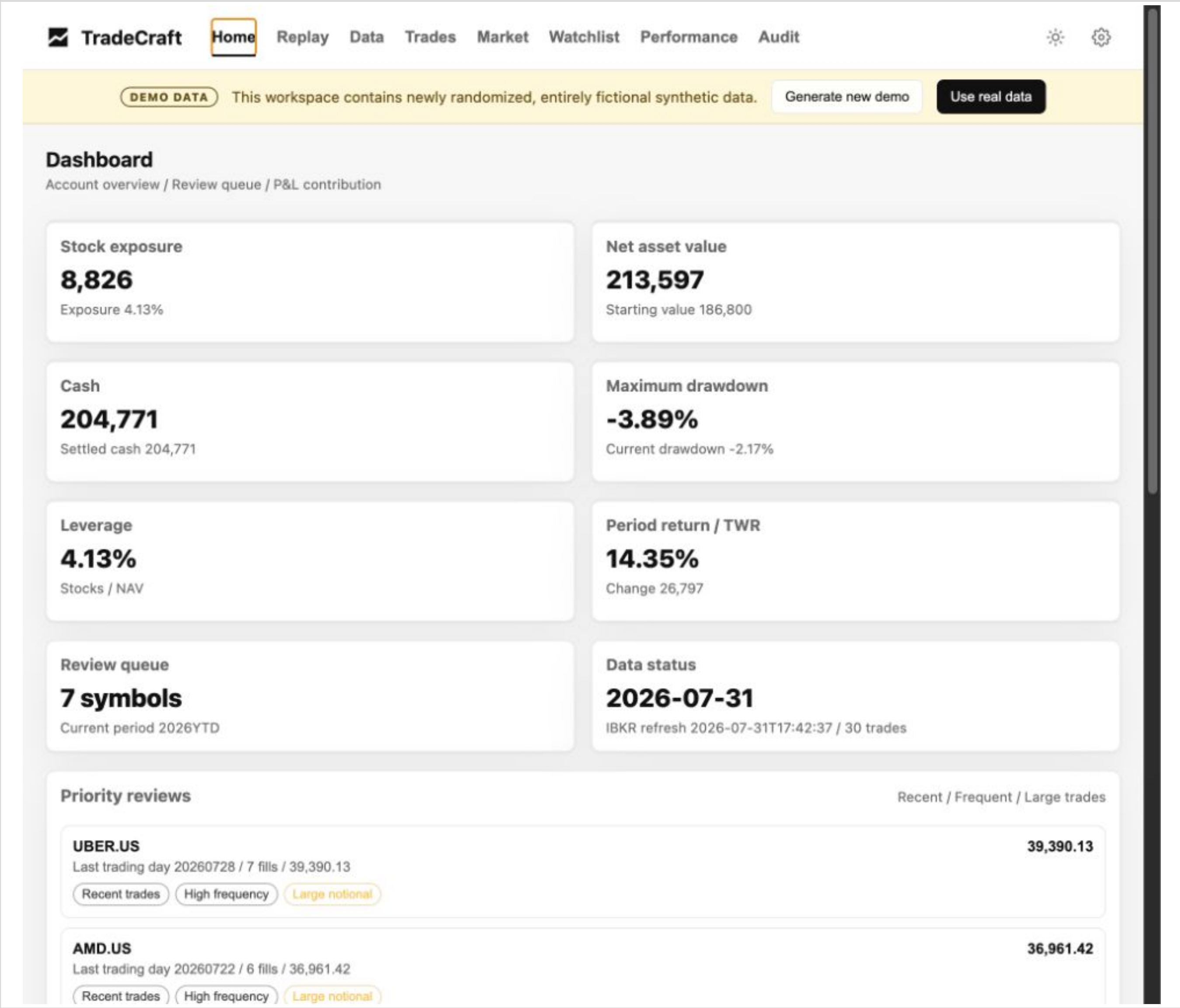
Open http://127.0.0.1:8888 in a desktop browser. The service is intentionally bound to the local loopback interface.

Convenience commands are also available:

```
make install
make run
make test
make smoke
```

2. First run and Demo mode

An empty workspace starts in Demo mode automatically. The yellow DEMO DATA banner means that the current account, trades, positions, performance, Watchlist, audit findings, and cached candles are entirely fictional.



English TradeCraft dashboard using randomized Demo data

Use Demo mode to learn the workflow safely:

1. Start on Home and identify the highest-priority symbol.
2. Open Replay to inspect the chart and the actual synthetic fills together.
3. Review Data and Performance to understand concentration and the account path.
4. Open Audit and drill from a finding into its underlying evidence.
5. Generate a new Demo at any time to replace the entire synthetic workspace.

Generate new demo creates a new internally consistent dataset. Use real data exits Demo mode and removes only files listed in the Demo manifest. Real uploads are rejected until Demo mode is exited, which prevents synthetic and real records from being mixed.

3. Import real IBKR data

1. Click Use real data in the Demo banner and confirm the exit.
2. Open Settings -> Data update.
3. Upload supported files, or place them in data/inbox/.
4. Click Refresh data.
5. Return to Home and confirm the data-through date and execution count before interpreting results.

Supported inputs include:

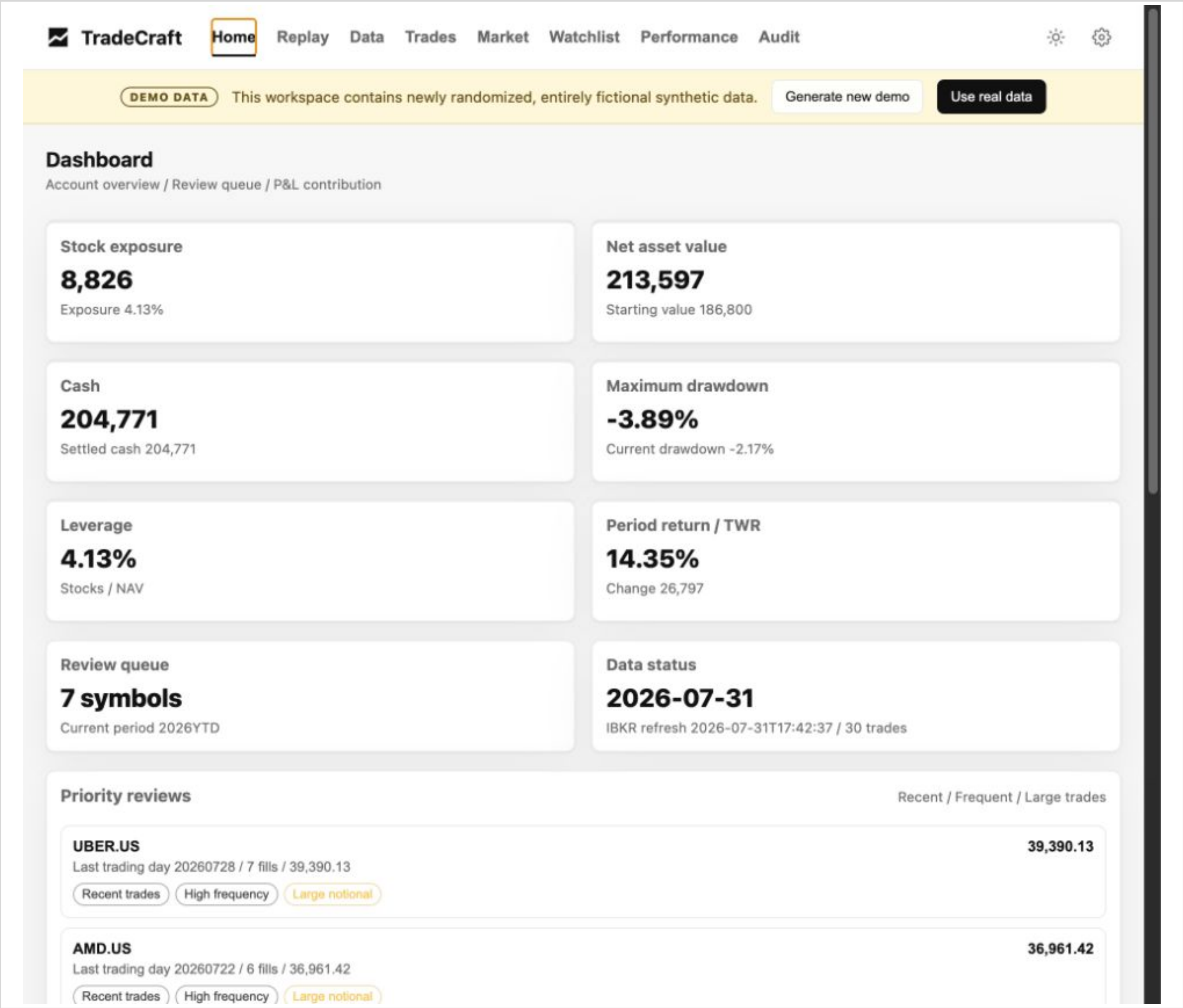
- IBKR .tlg stock trade logs;
- Activity Statement CSV files for snapshots, positions, and mark-to-market values;
- Transaction History CSV files as a fill fallback;
- MTM Summary CSV files;
- an optional performance workbook in data/inbox/ or configured with TRADECRAFT_PERFORMANCE_FILE.

Never commit broker exports, generated state, workbooks, local databases, logs, or .env files. Each checkout should own its own runtime workspace.

4. Daily review workflow

4.1 Home - decide what deserves attention first

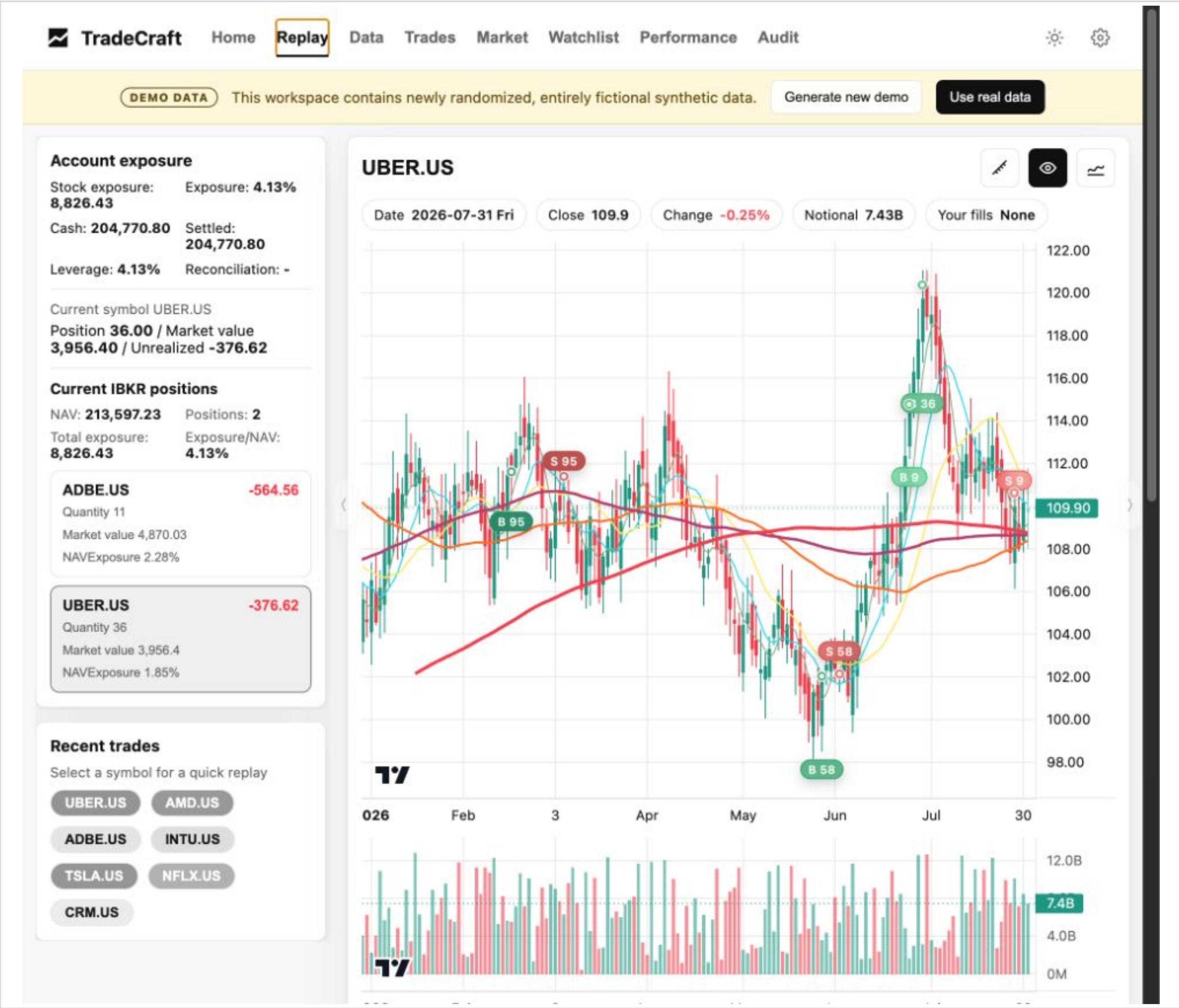
Home combines net asset value, stock exposure, cash, drawdown, leverage, period return, data freshness, a review queue, and the largest P&L contributors. Confirm data freshness first, then choose one to three symbols that deserve a deeper review.



English Home dashboard

4.2 Replay - reconstruct the decision from evidence

Replay places adjusted daily candles, volume, moving averages, BUY and SELL markers, and fill-level records on one timeline. The left side summarizes account exposure and recent symbols. The right side contains the selected day details and the trade-plan form.



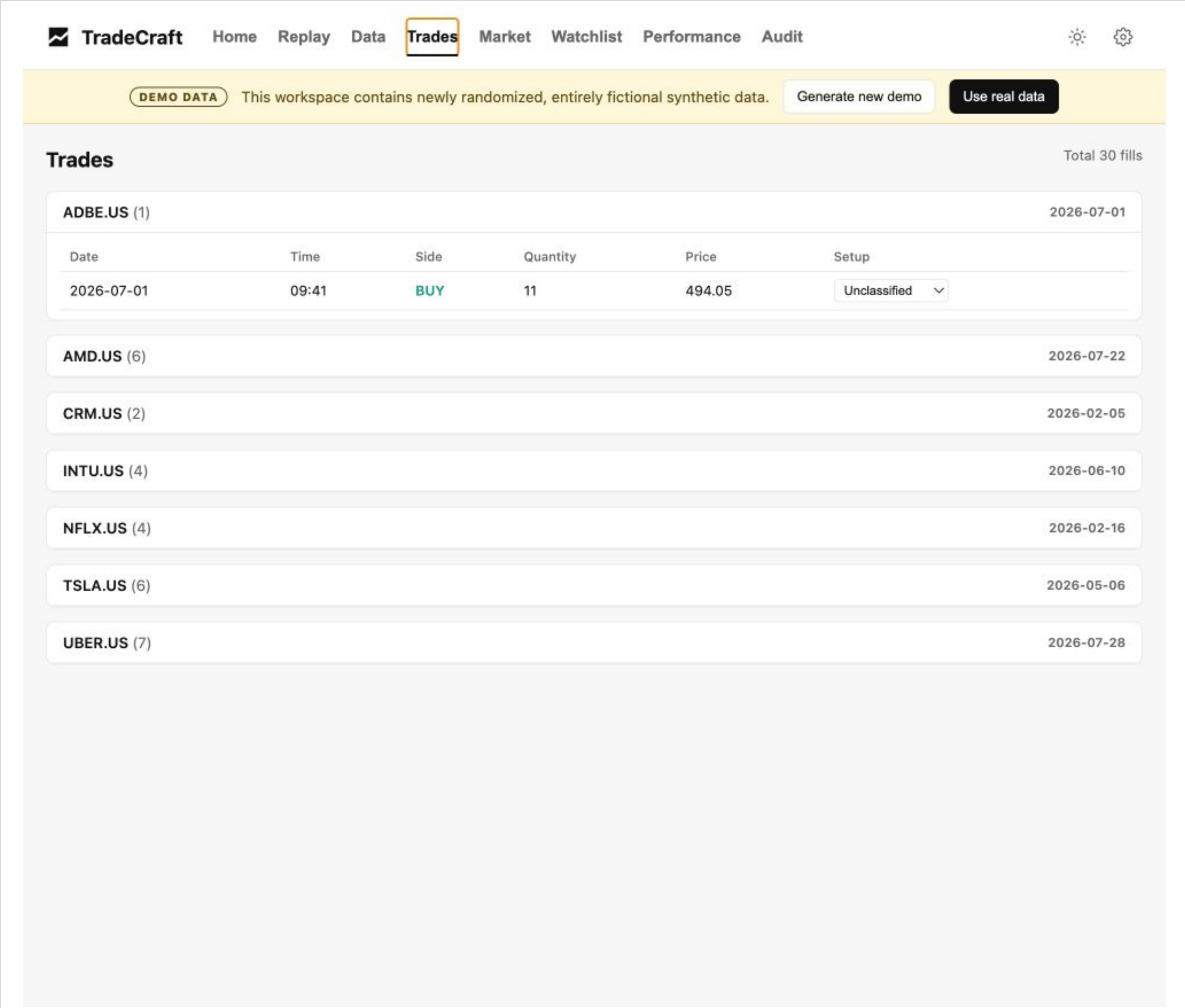
English symbol-level Replay

Recommended Replay sequence:

1. Select the symbol and date that matter.
2. Check the market position of every fill instead of relying on memory.
3. Compare the entry and exit with the original invalidation level and holding horizon.
4. Record the thesis, add/reduce conditions, stop condition, setup tag, and review note.
5. Save the plan so later audit evidence can distinguish missing data from a process error.

4.3 Trades - return to the underlying fills

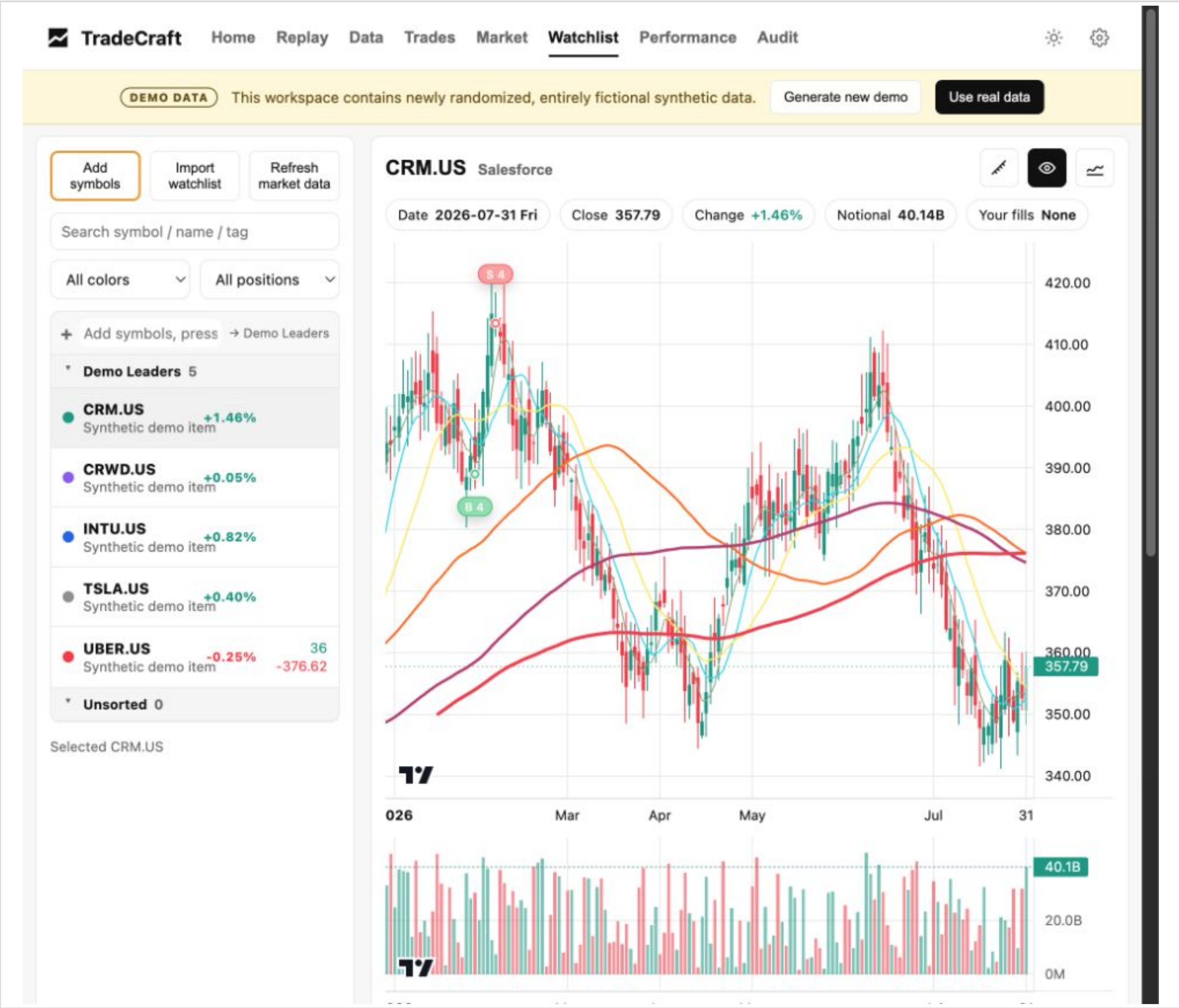
Trades groups executions by symbol. Expand a symbol to inspect dates, times, sides, quantities, prices, and setup classifications. This is the fill-level source for FIFO round trips and evidence drill-down.



English execution records

4.4 Watchlist - maintain a local research queue

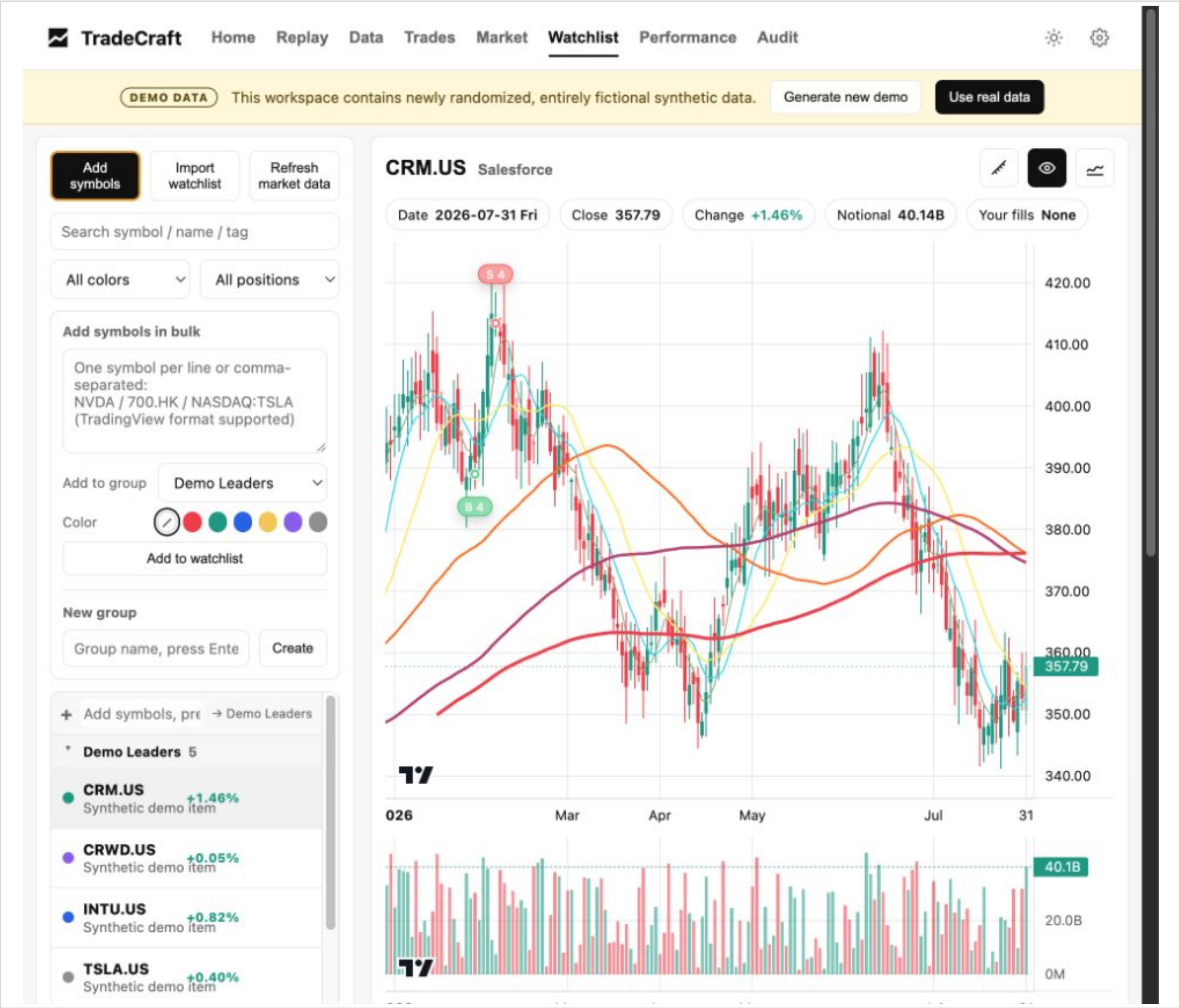
Watchlist is a local, SQLite-backed research queue with groups, colors, sorting, search, charts, position context, and trigger fields. Use it to separate candidates from active positions and to record what must happen before a candidate becomes actionable.



English Watchlist workspace

4.5 Add symbols - build a candidate pool efficiently

Click Add symbols to add one or more tickers, select a target group, assign a color, or create a new group. The bulk field accepts one symbol per line, comma-separated symbols, and common TradingView Watchlist formats.

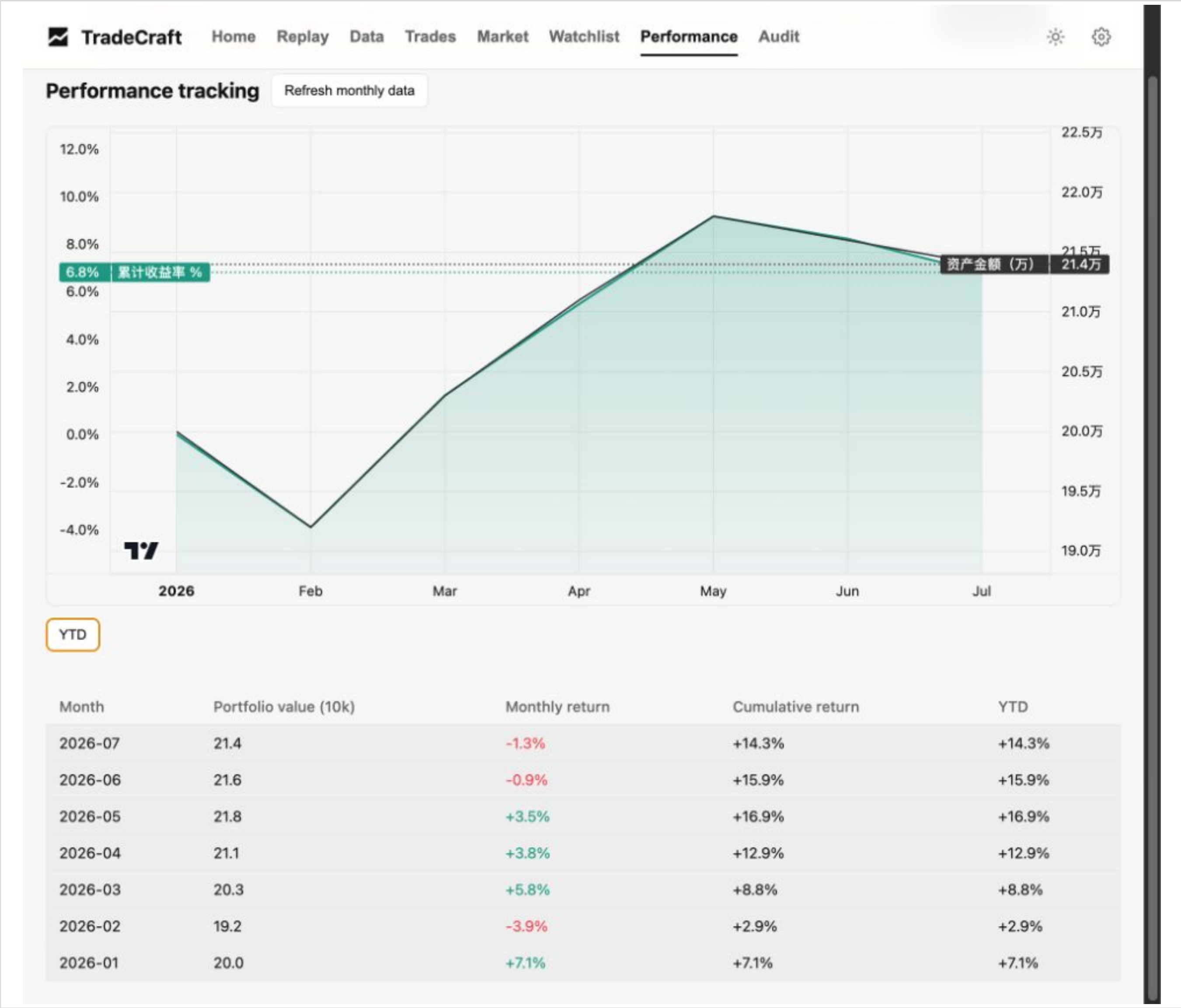


English Add symbols panel

5. Review the account path

5.1 Performance - inspect the path, not only the ending value

Performance shows monthly account values, monthly returns, cumulative returns, and YTD returns. Use it to distinguish steady progress from a result dominated by one large win or a recovery after a deep drawdown.

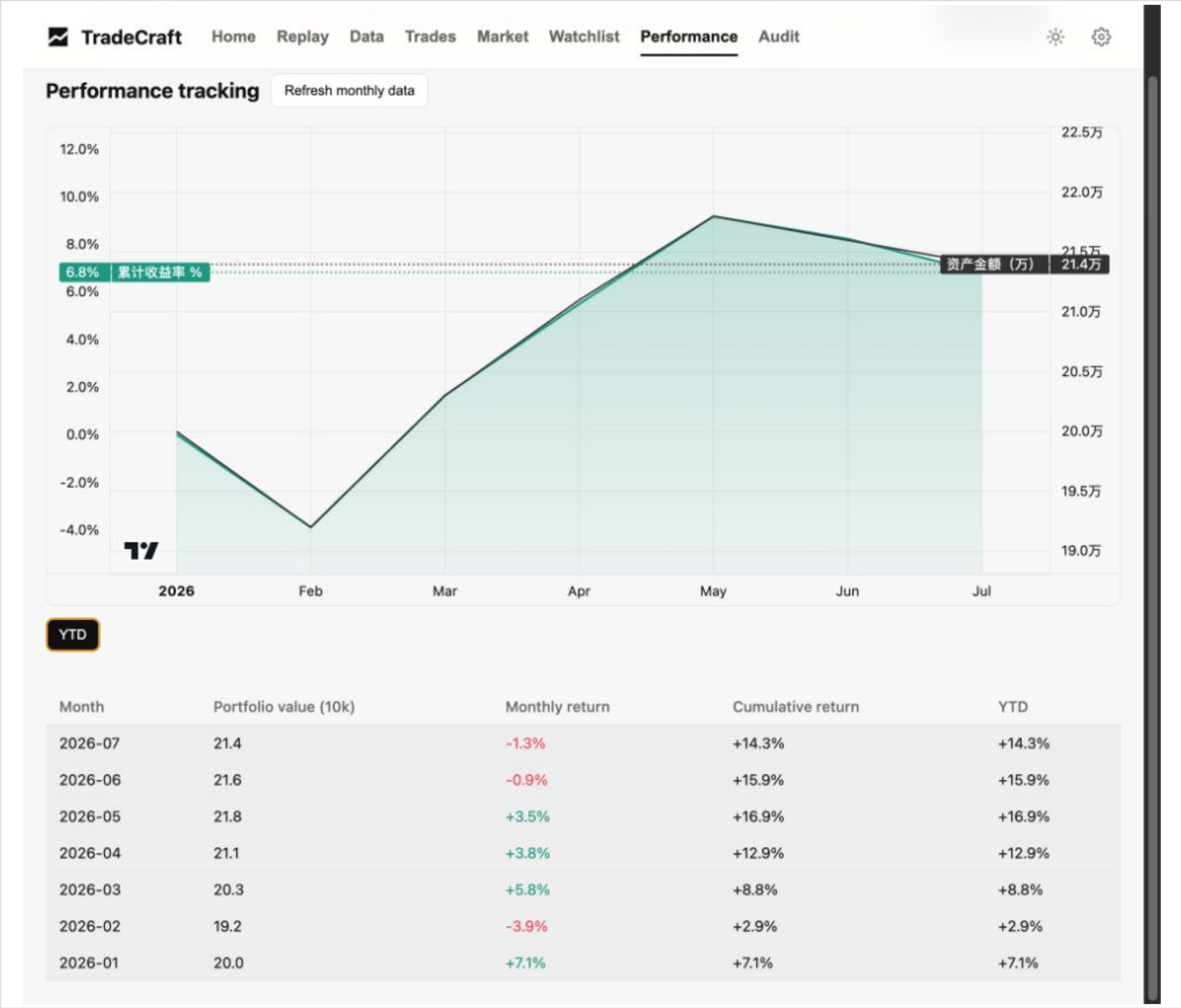


Month	Portfolio value (10k)	Monthly return	Cumulative return	YTD
2026-07	21.4	-1.3%	+14.3%	+14.3%
2026-06	21.6	-0.9%	+15.9%	+15.9%
2026-05	21.8	+3.5%	+16.9%	+16.9%
2026-04	21.1	+3.8%	+12.9%	+12.9%
2026-03	20.3	+5.8%	+8.8%	+8.8%
2026-02	19.2	-3.9%	+2.9%	+2.9%
2026-01	20.0	+7.1%	+7.1%	+7.1%

English Performance page

5.2 YTD view - isolate the current year

Click YTD to focus the chart on the current year. This is useful when a strategy or risk process changed recently and older history would dilute the comparison.



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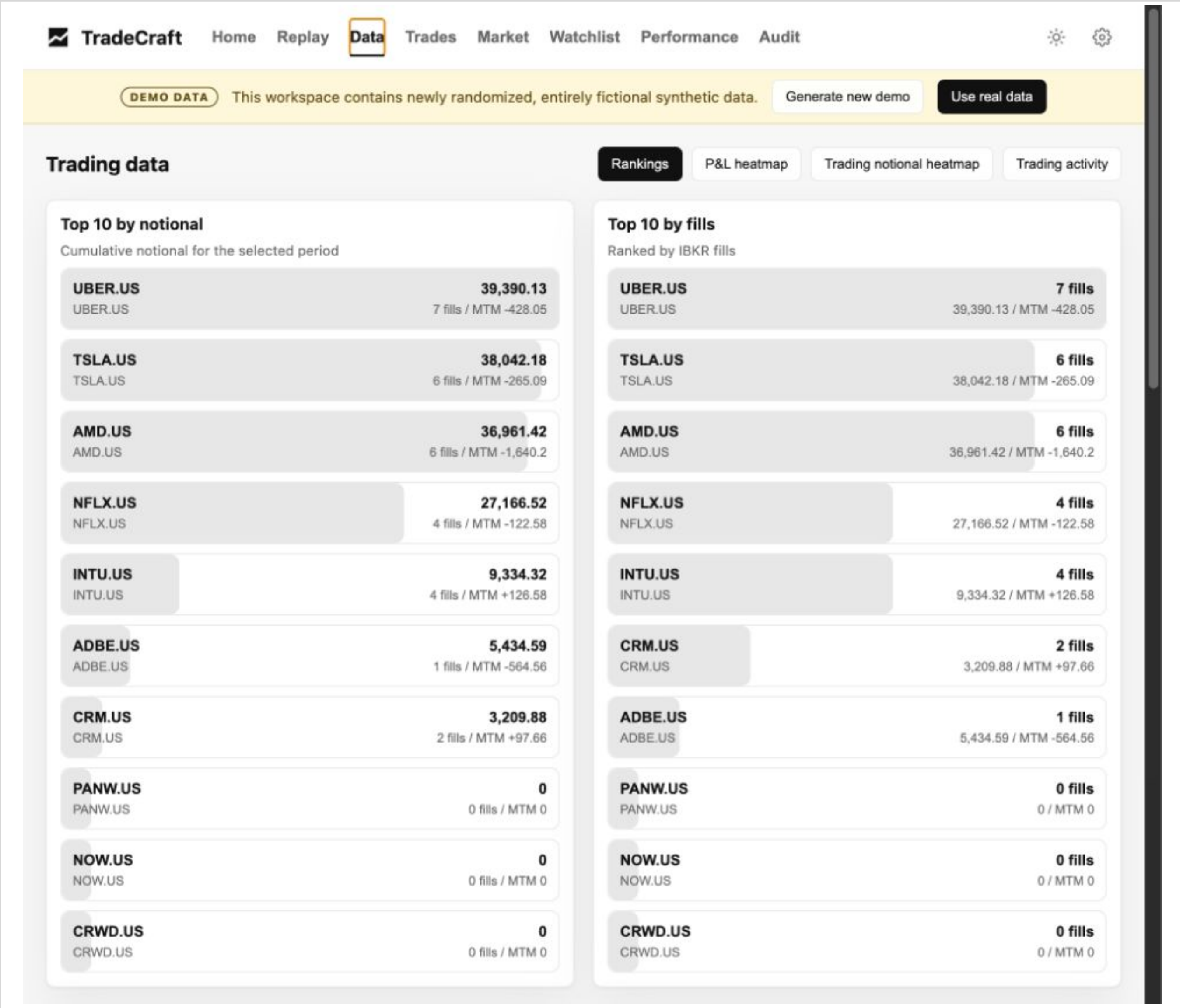
2026-05	21.8	+3.5%	+16.9%	+16.9%
2026-04	21.1	+3.8%	+12.9%	+12.9%
2026-03	20.3	+5.8%	+8.8%	+8.8%
2026-02	19.2	-3.9%	+2.9%	+2.9%
2026-01	20.0	+7.1%	+7.1%	+7.1%

English Performance YTD view

6. Understand capital and attention

6.1 Rankings

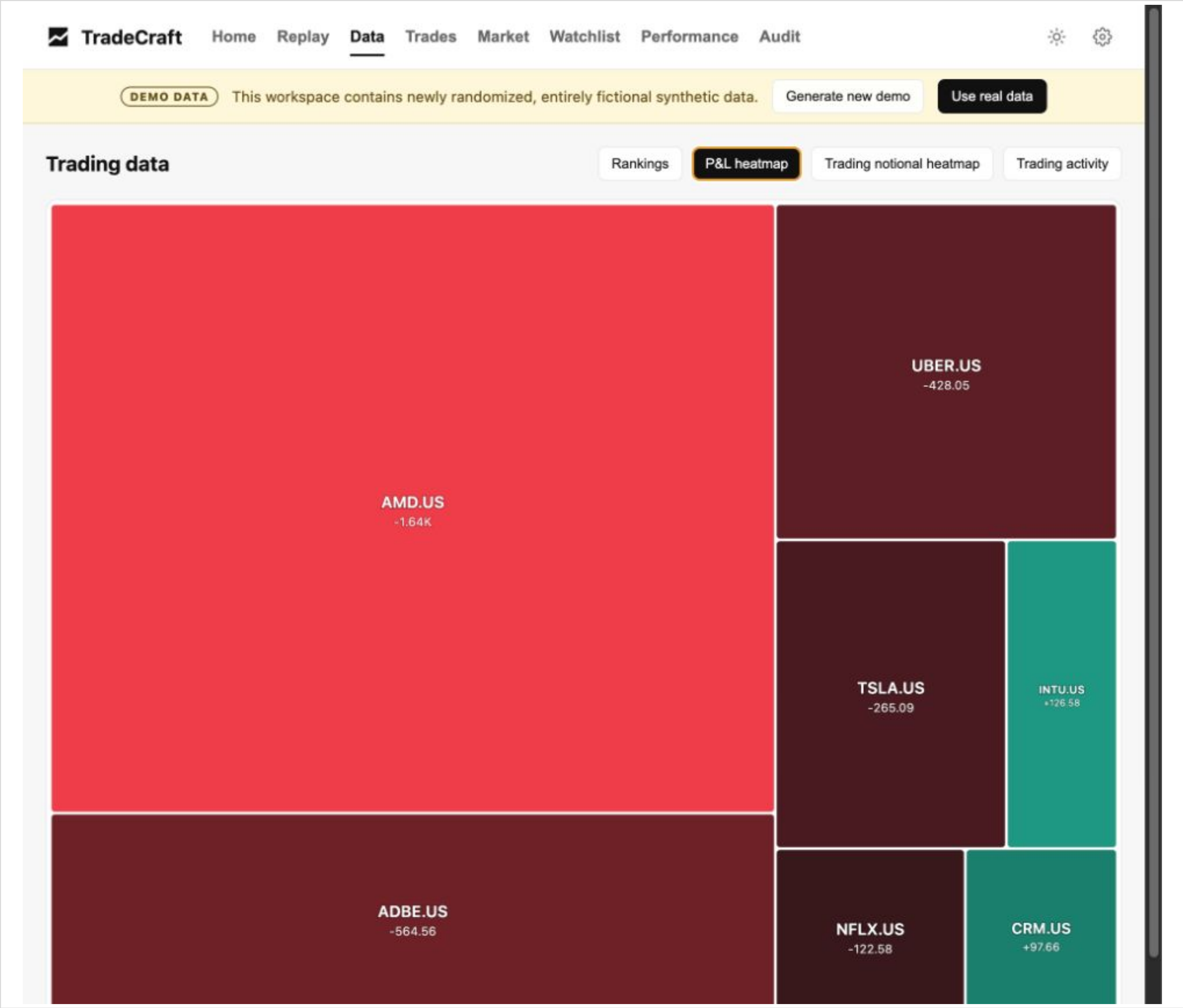
Rankings show the symbols with the largest trading notional, the most fills, the largest gains and losses, and non-stock instrument P&L. Use the page to compare where you believed your attention went with where capital and executions actually went.



English trading-data rankings

6.2 P&L heatmap

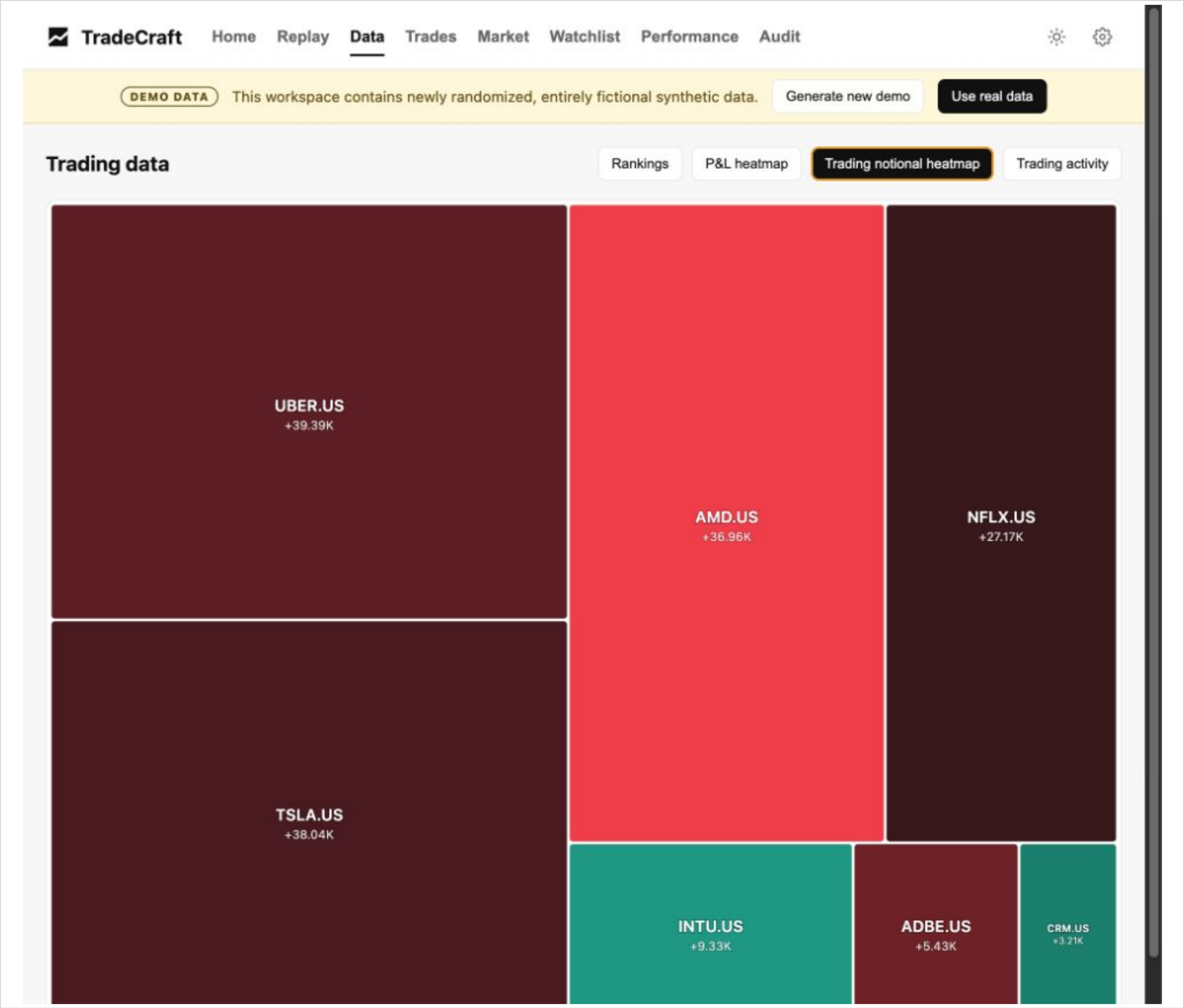
The P&L heatmap uses area for relative contribution and color for direction. It makes result concentration visible immediately.



English P&L heatmap

6.3 Trading notional heatmap

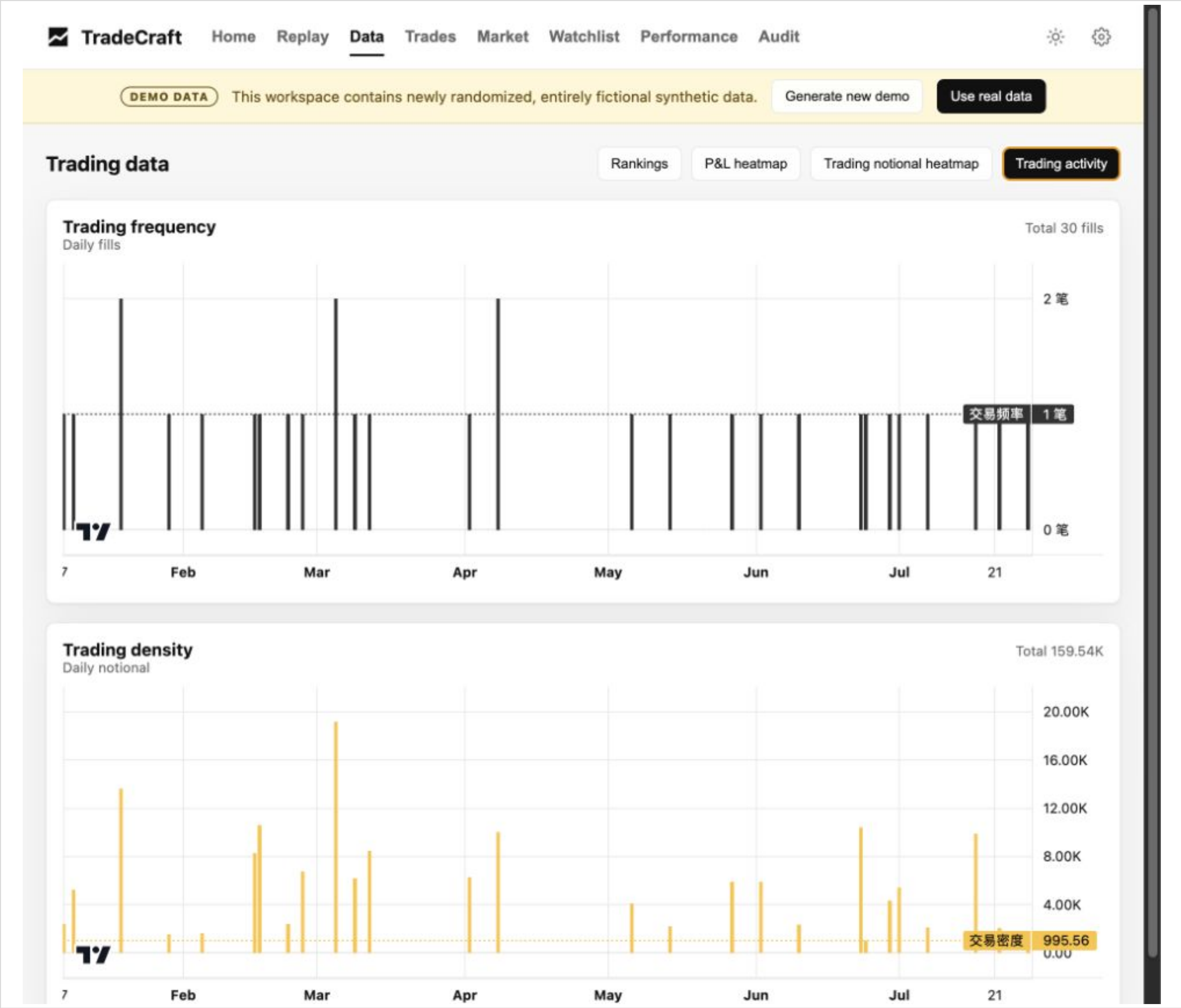
The trading-notional heatmap shows cumulative traded capital. Compare it with P&L contribution to identify excessive turnover, weak capital efficiency, or sizing that did not match conviction.



English trading-notional heatmap

6.4 Trading activity

Trading activity plots daily fill count and traded amount over time. Look for bursts of frequency or notional that may indicate overtrading, emotional acceleration, or an unusual event window.

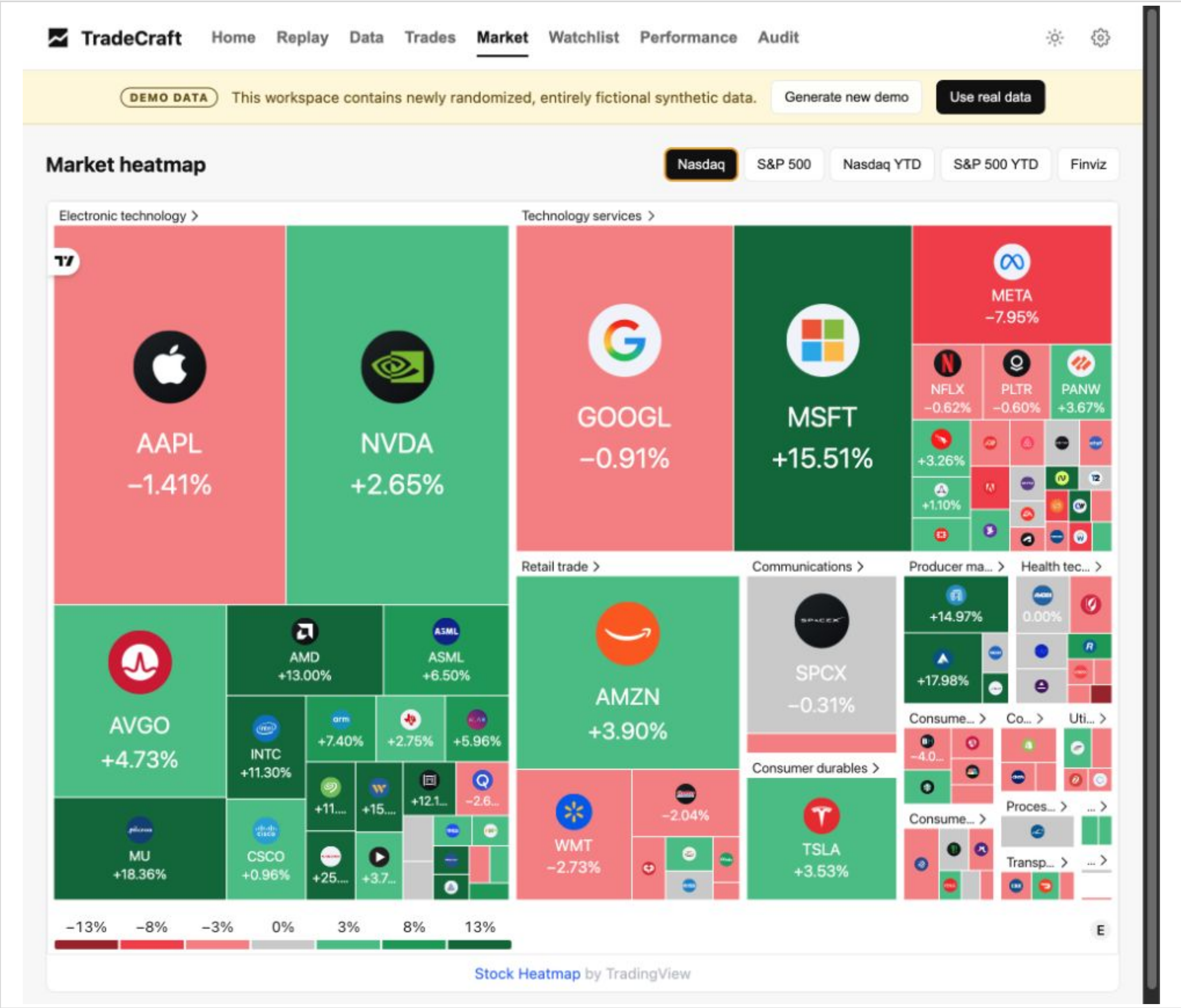


English trading-activity charts

7. Add market context

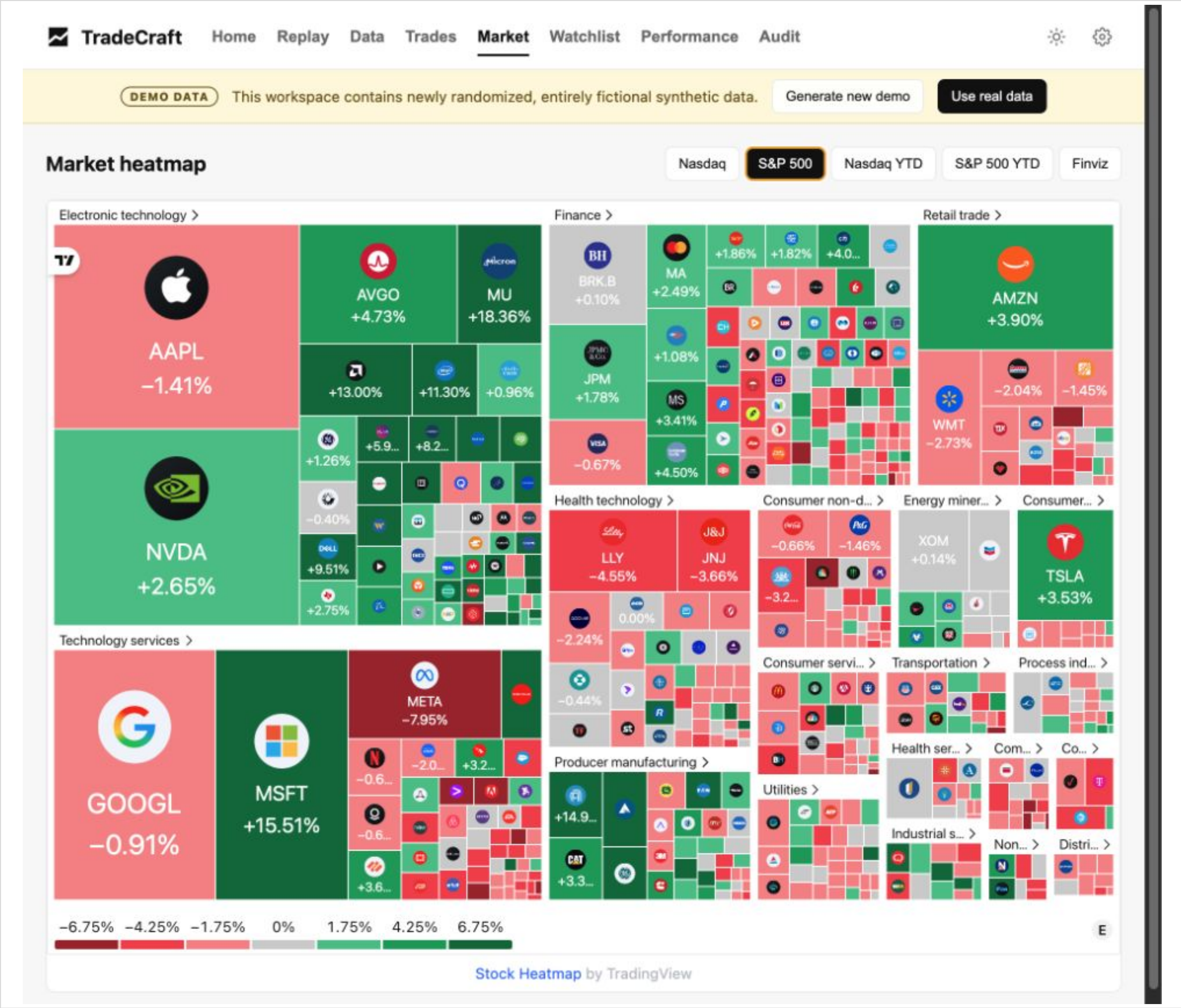
The Market page uses visible third-party TradingView and Finviz surfaces. These widgets require network access but do not receive local account or execution data from TradeCraft.

7.1 Nasdaq daily heatmap



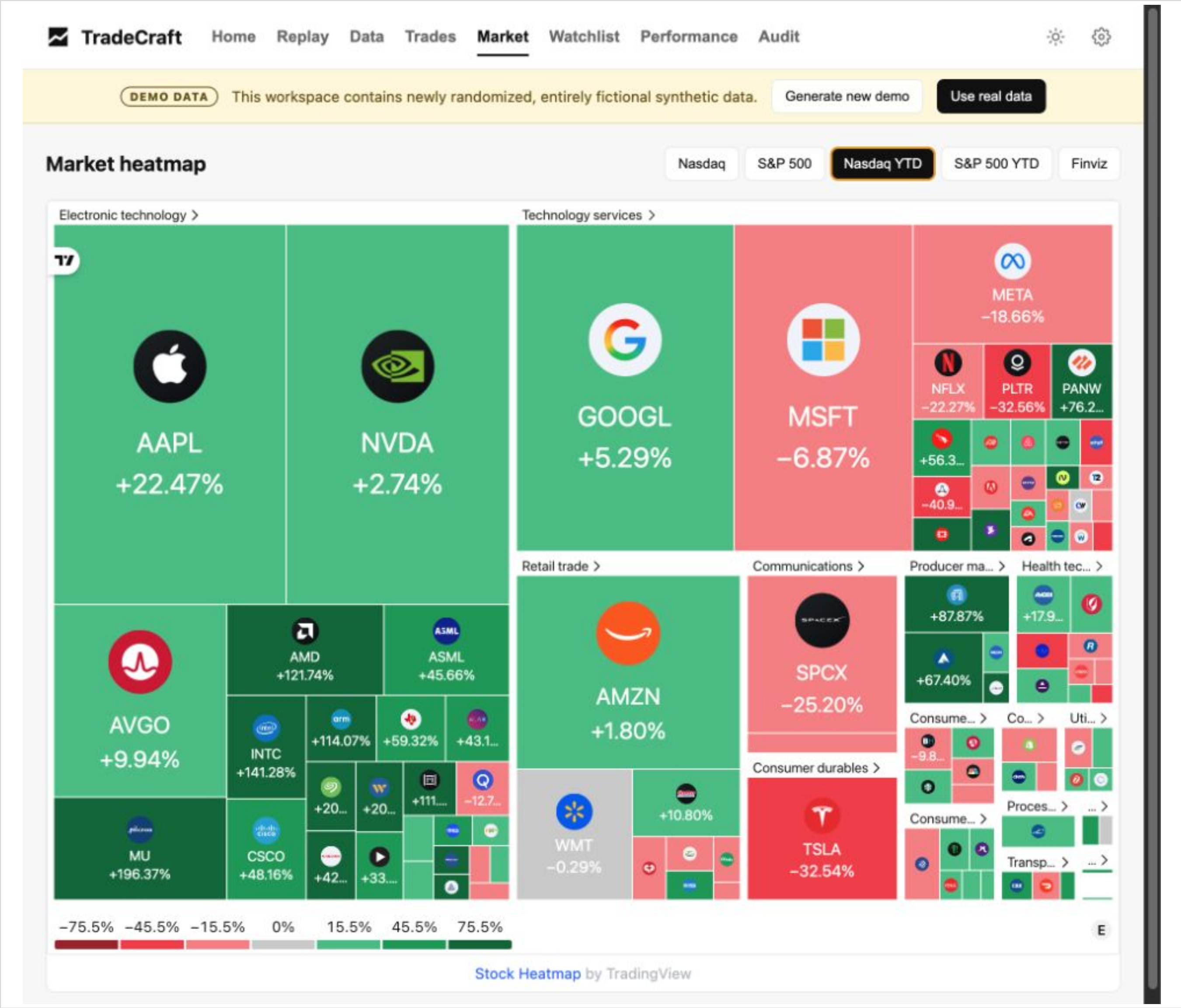
English Nasdaq daily heatmap

7.2 S&P 500 daily heatmap



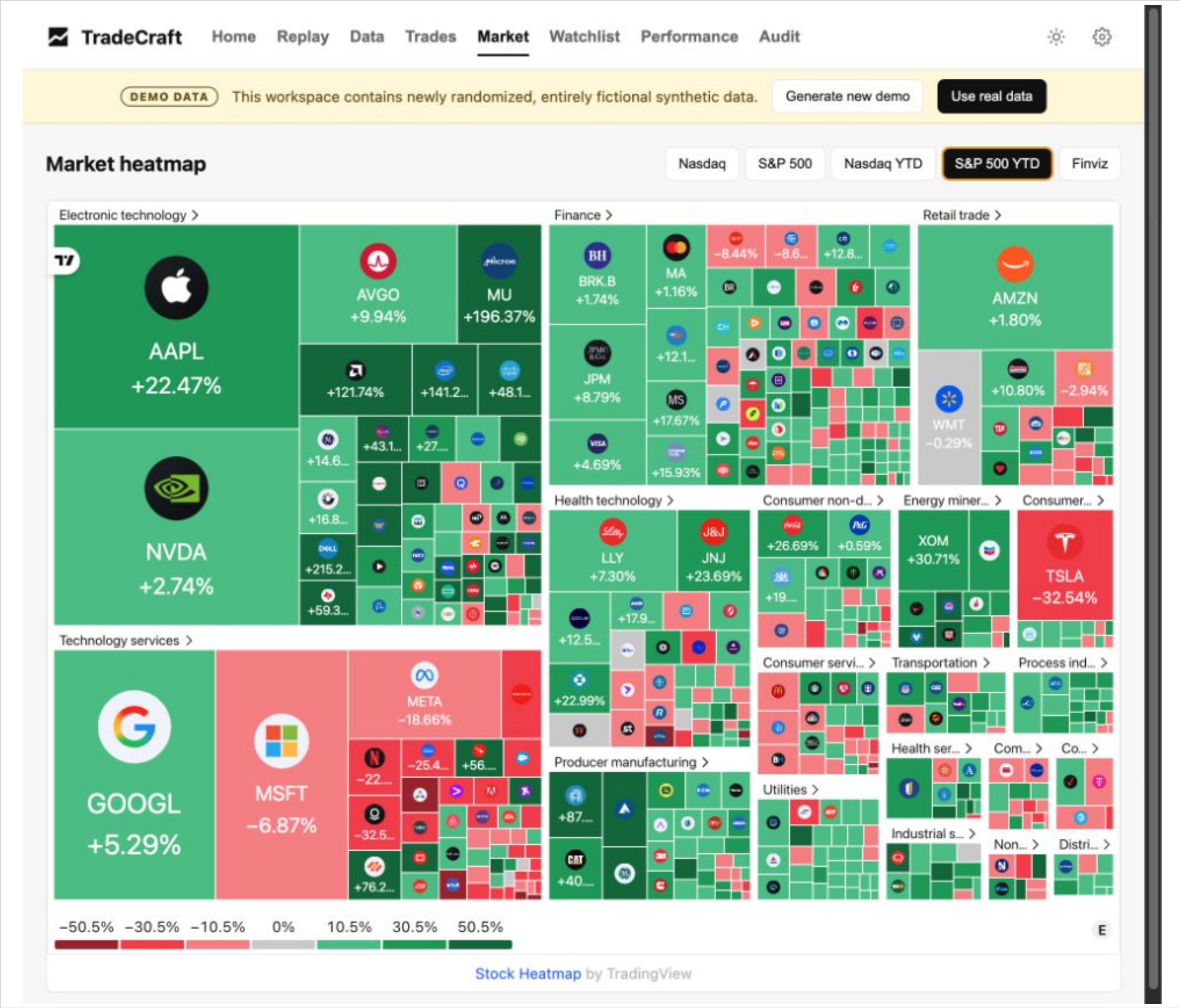
English S&P 500 daily heatmap

7.3 Nasdaq YTD heatmap



English Nasdaq YTD heatmap

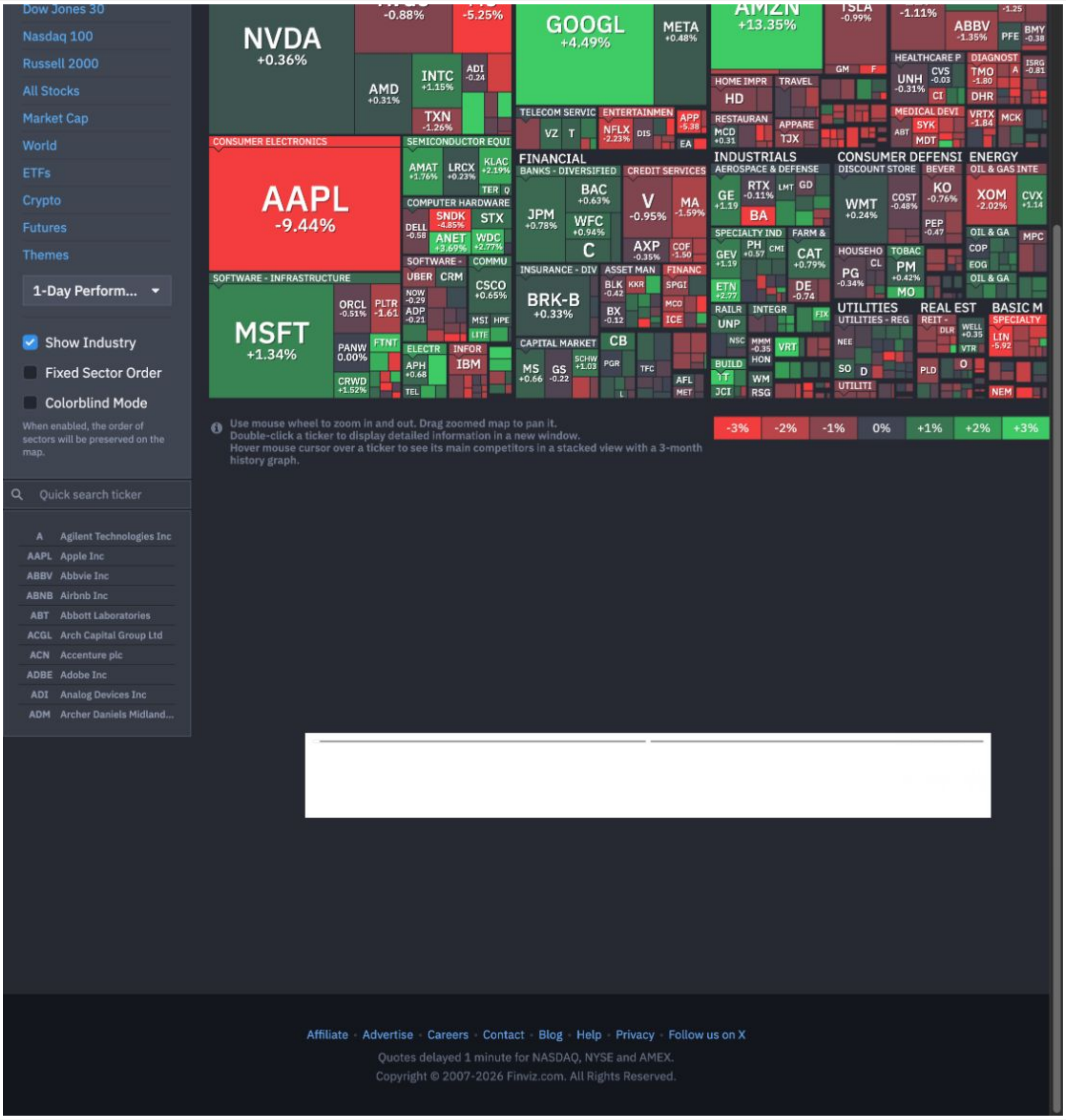
7.4 S&P 500 YTD heatmap



English S&P 500 YTD heatmap

7.5 Finviz map

Finviz opens in a separate browser tab. Use it as an additional external market-map view.



English Finviz S&P 500 map

Do not interpret broad market strength as proof of stock-selection skill. Compare account results with the selected benchmark and use the heatmaps only as context.

8. Use the evidence-first Audit workbench

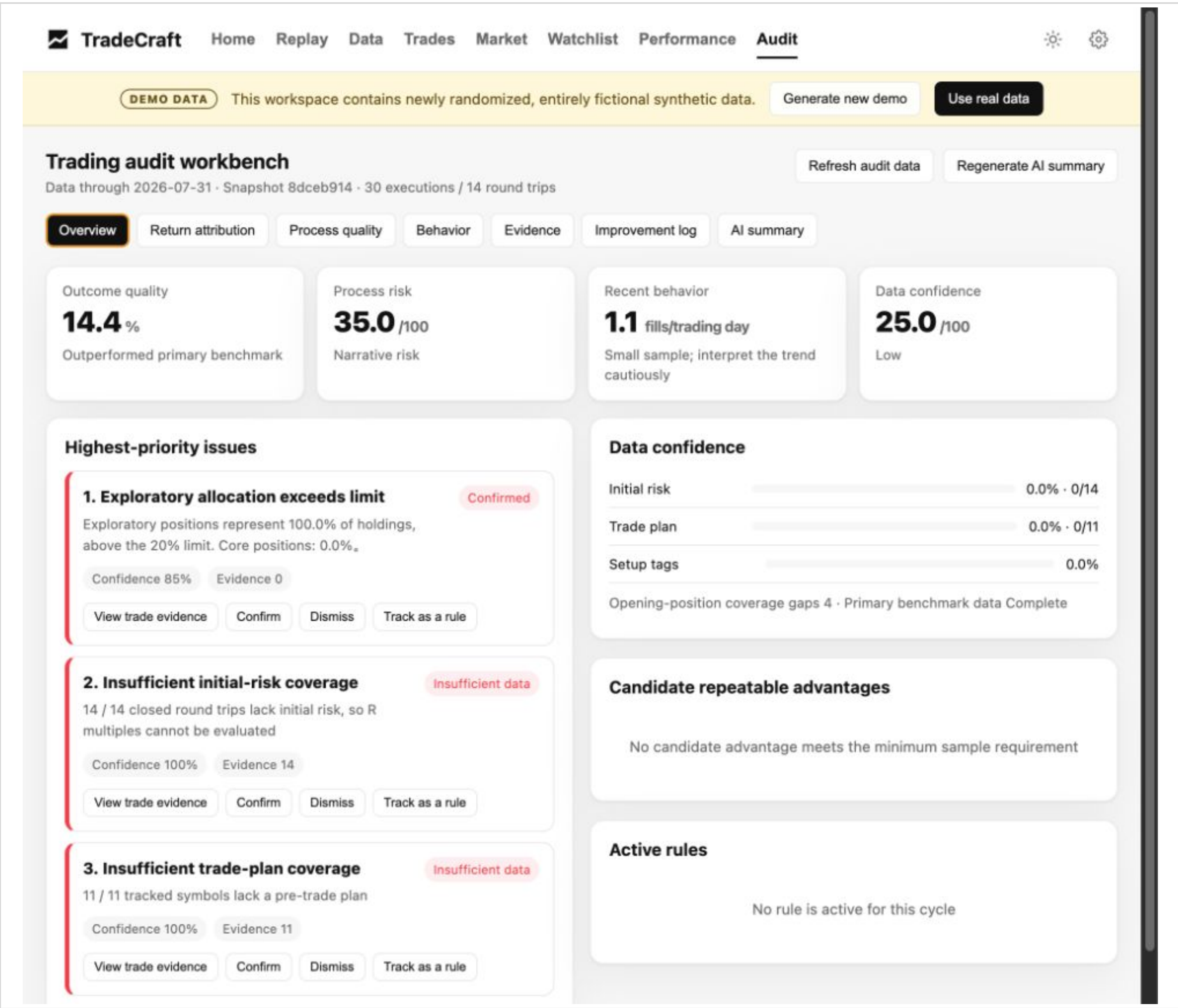
The Audit score is a risk diagnostic: 0 means lower observed process risk and 100 means higher risk. It is not a personality score or a return forecast. Every finding should be traceable to the current dataset and complete trade evidence.

The workbench keeps four questions separate:

- Outcome: what drove the account and trade results?
- Process: were entry, exit, sizing, concentration, and selection sound?
- Behavior: which patterns changed or repeated?
- Confidence: which conclusions are supported, suspected, or blocked by missing data?

8.1 Overview

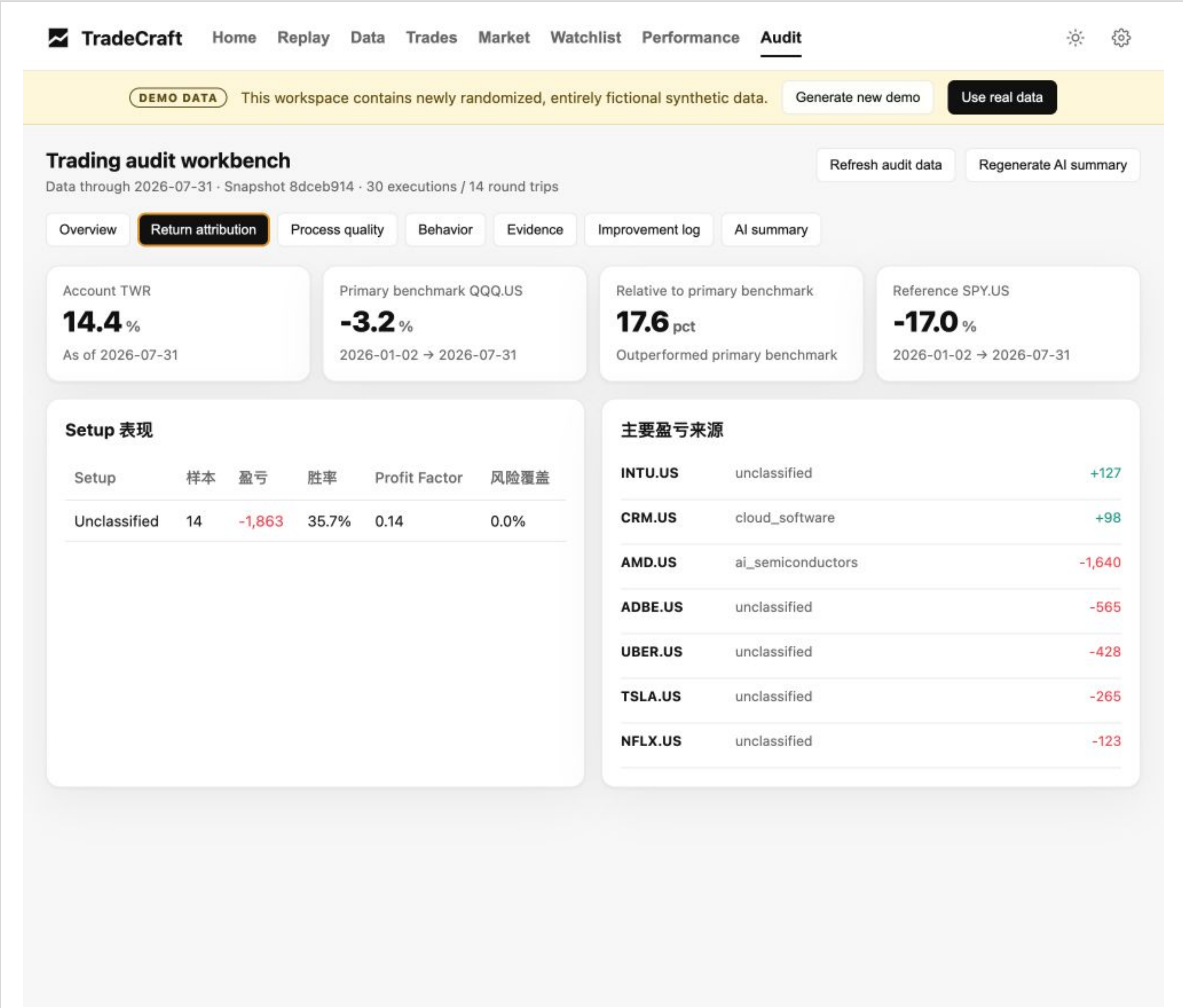
Overview presents outcome, process, behavior, and confidence scorecards together with the highest-priority findings and the current improvement rule.



English Audit overview

8.2 Return attribution

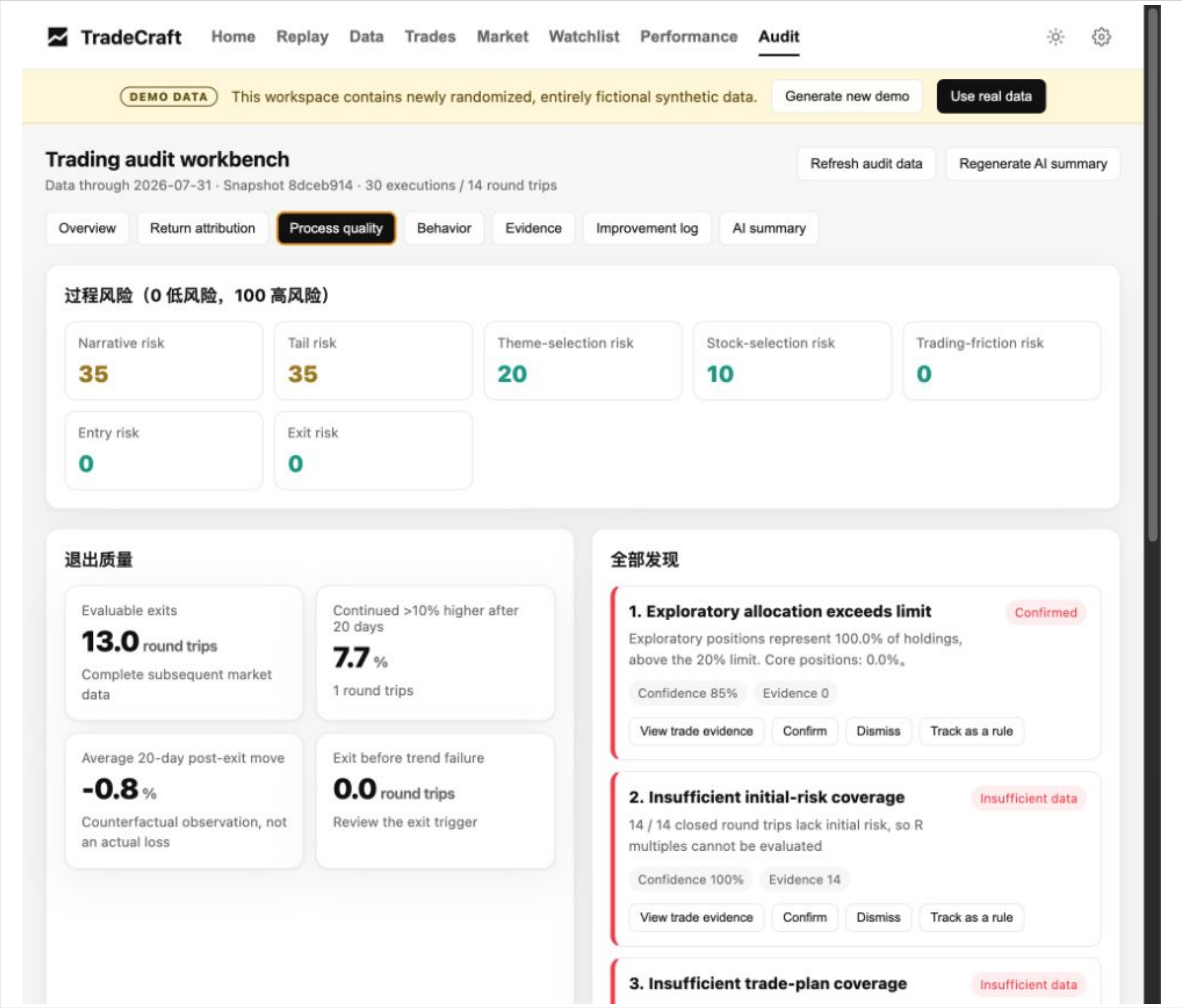
Return attribution compares account TWR with the primary and reference benchmarks, then shows setup results and the largest positive and negative contributors.



English return attribution

8.3 Process quality

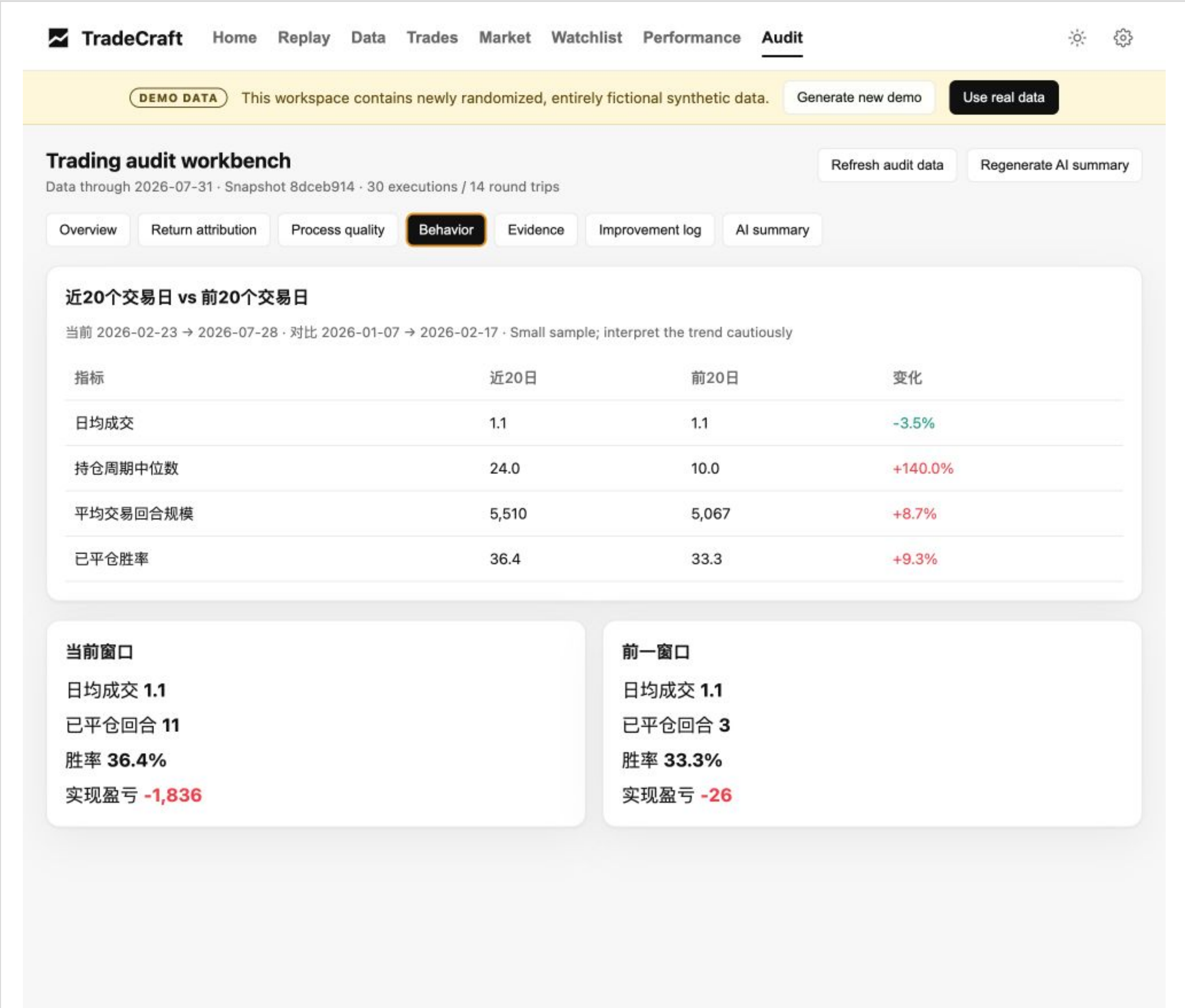
Process quality reviews seven weighted risk dimensions: churn and friction, stock selection, entry quality, tail risk, theme judgment, narrative hype, and exit quality.



English process-quality view

8.4 Behavior

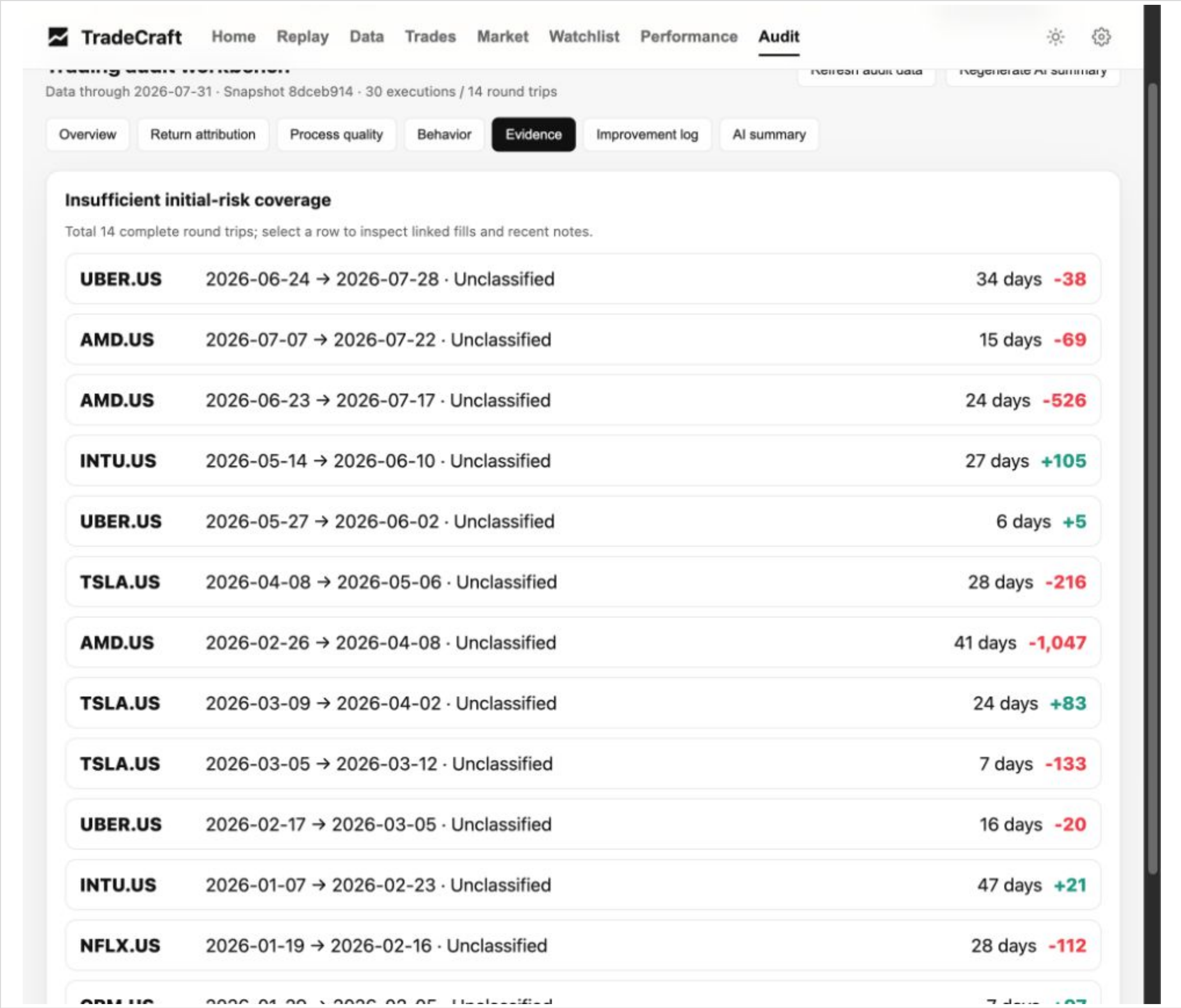
Behavior compares the most recent 20 active trading days with the previous 20-day window. Use it to identify changes in frequency, holding period, size, and win rate.



English behavior comparison

8.5 Evidence

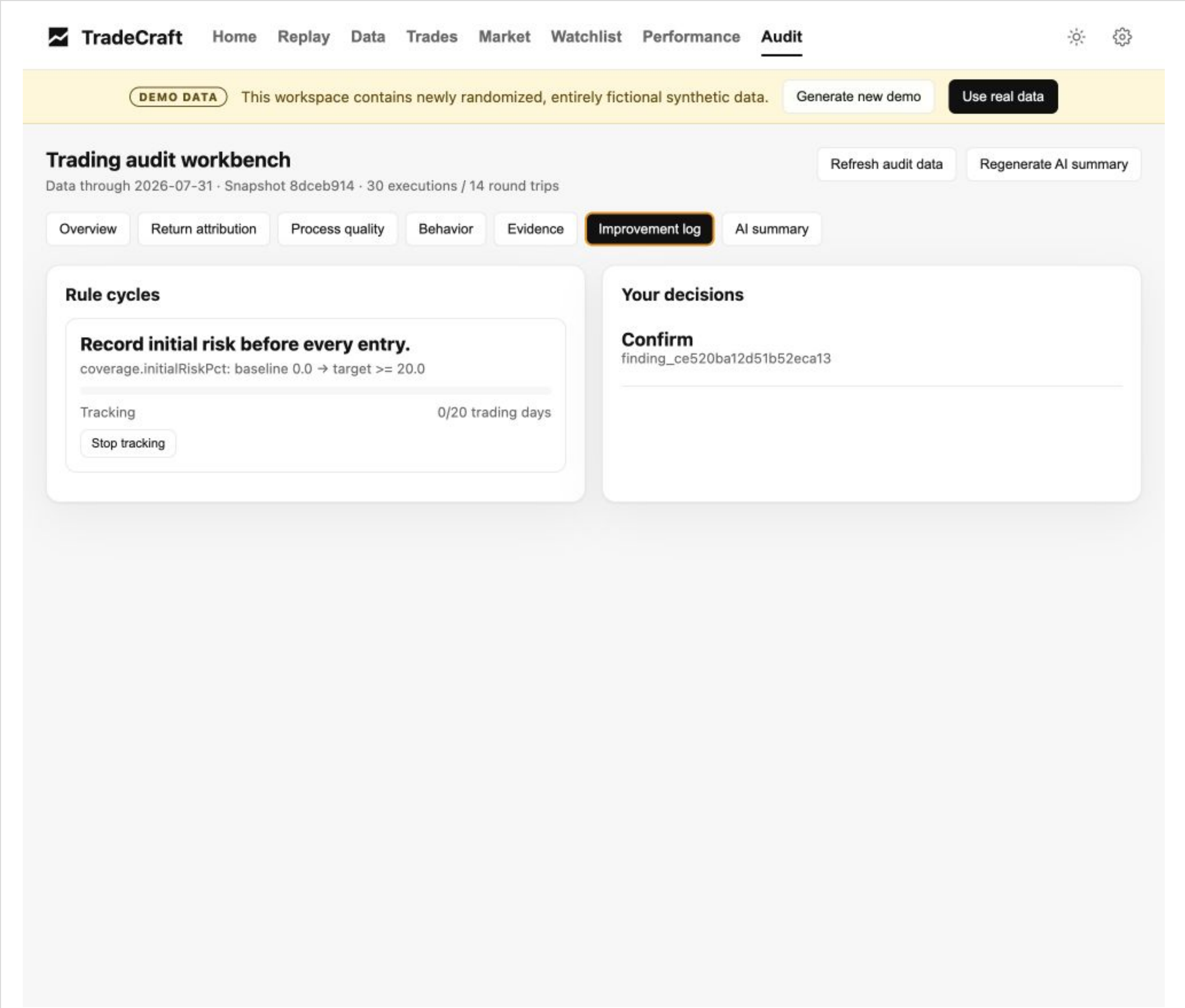
Evidence drills from a finding into complete BUY and SELL round trips, related fills, holding days, and realized P&L. Add missing plan or review context before confirming a conclusion.



English trade evidence

8.6 Improvement log

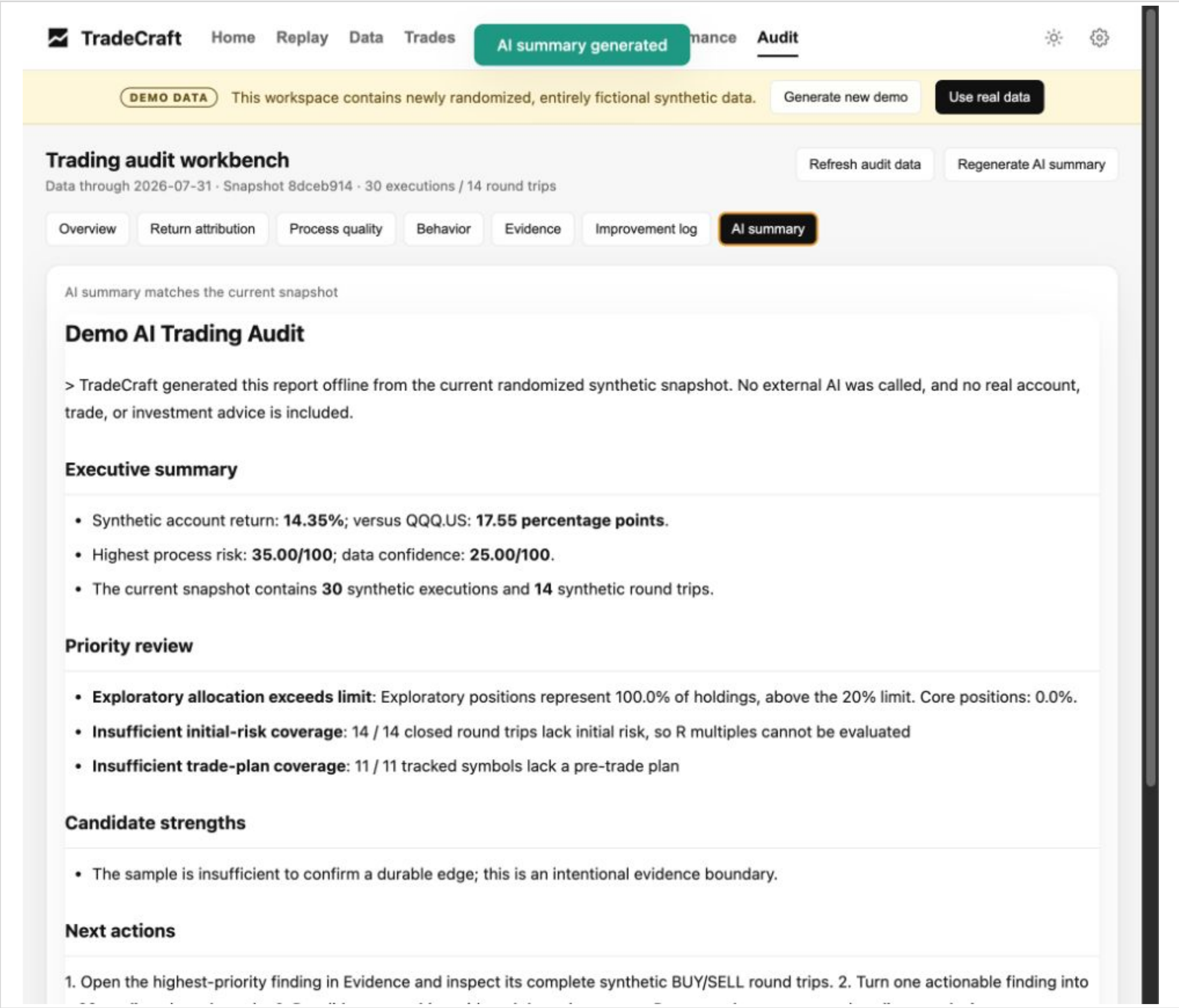
The improvement log records confirmed or dismissed findings and tracks a selected rule over the next 20 trading days. A useful rule has a baseline, target, measurement window, and completion result.



English improvement log

8.7 AI summary

The optional AI summary compresses the current deterministic audit snapshot. It does not calculate P&L, FIFO matching, attribution, or risk scores. In Demo mode, the English summary is generated offline and no external provider is called.

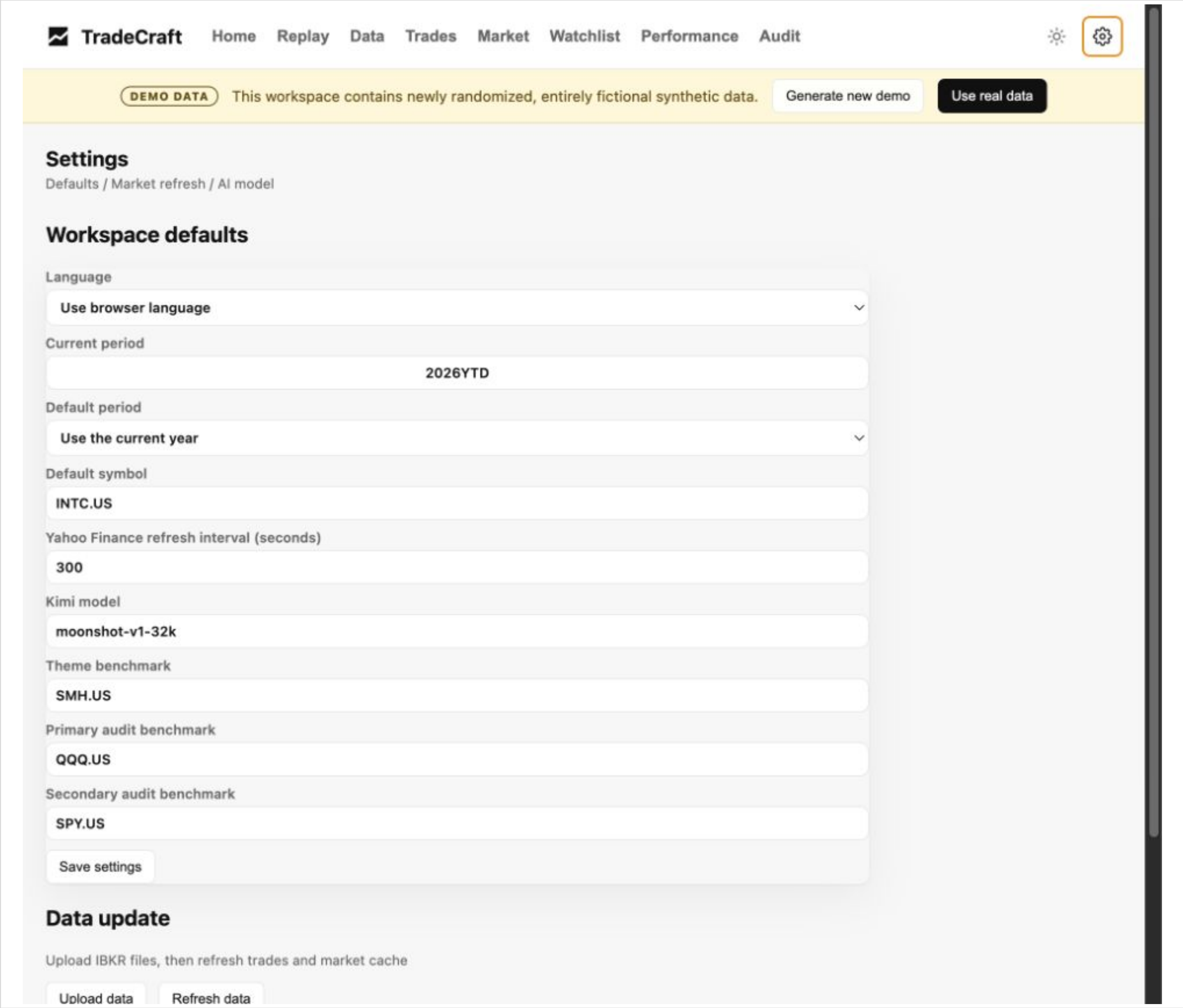


English Demo AI summary

For a real workspace, Kimi is called only after the user explicitly selects Generate AI summary and a local API key is configured.

9. Settings

Settings controls language, default period, default symbol, market-data refresh interval, Kimi model, theme benchmark, audit benchmarks, data upload and refresh, and Watchlist triggers.



English Settings page

The language options are:

- Use browser language: zh* uses Simplified Chinese; all other languages fall back to English;
- English;
- 简体中文.

The selected value is saved locally. API clients can also use Accept-Language or ?lang=en and ?lang=zh-CN.

10. Recommended review cadence

Every trading day:

- verify data freshness, exposure, cash, drawdown, and priority symbols on Home;
- review one to three important trades in Replay;
- resolve one high-priority Audit finding or add the missing evidence;
- update the Watchlist condition that matters most.

Every week:

- compare P&L contribution with trading notional and activity;
- remove stale Watchlist candidates and update groups or triggers;
- compare current market breadth with YTD leadership;
- check whether recent behavior differs from the previous 20-day window.

Every month:

- review the account path, monthly return, cumulative return, and drawdown recovery;
- recheck all seven process-risk dimensions;
- close or extend completed 20-day rule cycles;
- treat candidate strengths as unproven until sample size and risk coverage are sufficient.

11. Privacy, networking, and AI boundaries

- The service listens on 127.0.0.1 by default.
- TradeCraft does not log in to a broker or place orders.
- There is no TradeCraft telemetry or TradeCraft cloud account.
- Runtime data and secrets are ignored by Git.
- Demo and real data are mutually exclusive.
- TradingView and Finviz are visible third-party network surfaces.
- Optional AI requires an explicit user action.
- Core parsing, FIFO matching, attribution, evidence, and scoring remain deterministic.

12. Troubleshooting

The page does not open:

- confirm that python app/main.py is still running;
- open http://127.0.0.1:8888, not a public network address;
- check /api/health for the resolved root, Python executable, and data state.

The interface is in the wrong language:

- open Settings and select English explicitly;
- reload the page after saving;
- confirm that document.documentElement.lang is en when debugging the browser.

Charts or market widgets are empty:

- local Replay and Watchlist charts require cached market data;
- use Settings to refresh local data;
- TradingView and Finviz require network access and may be blocked by browser privacy settings.

Audit findings are marked as insufficient data:

- add trade plans, invalidation levels, initial risk, and review notes;
- refresh the audit snapshot;
- do not upgrade a candidate strength into a proven edge without sufficient history.

13. Product boundary

TradeCraft is designed to make important decisions recorded, important conclusions traceable, repeated mistakes measurable, and candidate strengths testable. It does not replace judgment, create trading signals, or guarantee future performance.

See DISCLAIMER.md (DISCLAIMER.md) for the financial disclaimer and SECURITY.md (SECURITY.md) for the security policy.